

Figure 5.26 *Lashkari Bazar, South Palace, Audience Hall I, detail of paintings. From Sourdel-Thomine 1978: pl. 9a.*

Bamiyan, the Shansabani lineage headed by Fakhr al-Din Mas'ud (r. AH 540–558/1145–63 CE) seemed to be cleaving toward palatial living, signaling an adaptive accommodation of the localized cultural and political economy of their immediate environment (cf. Chapter 3). At Ghazna also, then, the newly established Shansabani lineage appeared to be adopting the prevalent modes of kingship and the most effective modes of its actuation, which they *de facto* had inherited from their Yamini–Ghaznavid predecessors.[53]

The processes that appear to be evidenced in the architectural traces of the Shansabani conquest of the Ghaznavids' erstwhile territories should *not*, however, be considered instantaneous or unidirectional. While Shansabani renovations and modifications of the Yaminis' palatial